

TERMINAL TASK — User Guide (v0.2.0)

A tiny always-on-top task HUD for Windows with a terminal soul. It lives as a small glowing ball at the edge of your screen; open it, type, done. Built for 2-second capture — no accounts, no cloud, your data never leaves your machine.

1. The Ball

When collapsed, the widget is a 60×60 floating ball docked at the screen edge. It tells you three things at a glance:

- **A number** — how many main tasks are still open today.
- ✓ — everything's done.
- >_ — empty day, nothing loaded.
- **Glow color** — green when relaxed, shifting toward red over the last 2 hours before your deadline. Red means overdue.

Click the ball to open the panel. Drag it to reposition. The tray icon does the same jobs: left-click toggles the panel, right-click gives Open / Hide / Reset Position / Quit.

Global hotkey: `Alt+X` (default) shows/hides the widget from anywhere. Rebind it with `/shortcut`.

2. The Panel

The panel is one list and one prompt. The header shows your deadline and a live countdown (DL 18:00 • T-1h24m). The progress bar (PROG: [██████████]) counts every leaf item, so ticking off subtasks visibly moves it.

Everything you do flows through the `>` prompt at the bottom:

- Type text + `Enter` → new task.
- Type `/` → command palette pops up with ghost autocomplete (press `→` or `Tab` to accept the suggestion).
- Hover any row → a small `[ ... ]` chip appears at its right edge; hover the chip to expand the action buttons (`[^][v][+][x]`). The chip stays tiny so long task text remains readable.
- The prompt changes color to tell you what mode you're in: **amber** `edit>` while editing, **cyan** `sub#3>` while chaining subtasks.

The panel auto-collapses when your mouse leaves it (unless you're typing). `Esc` also steps you back: cancel mode → deselect → collapse.

3. Working with Tasks

Adding

Input	Result
<code>some text</code> + <code>Enter</code>	New task (it flashes and scrolls into view)

Input	Result
> some text or - some text	Subtask under the selected task (or the last one, so task ↵ → > sub ↵ chains) — it flashes where it lands
/l text	Into the backlog (long-term list at the bottom)
/daily text	Recurring ritual — reseeds as a fresh task every morning

Rapid subtask entry

Select a task (arrows or hover) and press > — or click its [+] button. The prompt turns cyan and every Enter chains another subtask under it. Empty Enter or Esc exits.

Completing

- **Click** a task's text (or a subtask's checkbox) to toggle it.
- **Space** toggles the selected item.
- Completing a parent completes its subtasks; completing the last subtask completes the parent.

Editing

- **Double-click** any task, subtask, or backlog text — it loads into the prompt (amber edit>), Enter saves, Esc cancels.
- Keyboard: select it and press Enter.

Deleting

- Hover → [x], or select and press Backspace/Delete.
- /clear wipes today's list (a notice reminds you: Ctrl+Z restores).

Reordering — the fun part

- **Carets:** hover a row, hover its [...] chip, and click [^] / [v]. The row *stays put* while a blurred cyan ghost line floats at the exact slot it will land in — keep clicking the same spot to move it further. Moving a parent task shows a condensed ghost (task text ·3 sub); its subtasks travel with it. The move commits automatically a moment after your last click (or when you move to another row). Esc aborts.
- **Alt + mouse wheel:** hover a row, hold Alt, scroll. The row rides the wheel.
- **Alt + ↑/↓:** same thing for keyboard users.
- Subtasks reorder within their parent; a moved task carries its subtasks with it. Any committed move is a single Ctrl+Z step.

Structure

- **Tab** (or the [»] button) demotes the selected task under the task above it. If it has subtasks of its own, they come along as siblings — nothing is lost.
- **Shift+Tab** (or [«] on a subtask) promotes it back to a full task, placed right below its old parent.

4. The Backlog

`/1 text` drops ideas into the **BACKLOG / LONG-TERM** section below your day list — things you don't want cluttering today. Bare `/1` jumps straight to the section. The header shows the item count, each item shows an age tag (`•3d`, amber at 14+ days), and once items start aging the header adds a nudge: *"2 aging — promote or prune."*

Promote one to today with its `[ > ]` button or by selecting it and pressing `Space` — it flashes at the bottom of your task list so you see where it went.

Lifecycle: backlog items persist across days — the day rollover never touches them; they only leave by being promoted or deleted. The widget applies gentle, escalating pressure as they age:

- 1. **Day 1+** — a dim `•3d` age tag appears on each item.
- 2. **Day 7+** — once per day, the oldest such item surfaces with a `~ consider today?` prompt: `[ > ]` promotes it, `[ x ]` snoozes the prompt until tomorrow.
- 3. **Day 14+** — the age tag turns amber and the section header counts them: *"2 aging — promote or prune."*

Editing works like everywhere else (double-click, or select + Enter); note that `Ctrl+Z` does **not** cover backlog deletes yet.

5. Deadline & Theme

`/deadline 18:00` sets **today's** deadline — it's one-time, not recurring, and clears automatically at the day rollover. From two hours out, the whole widget's glow slides green → yellow → red; past the deadline the countdown flips to `T+...` in red. One glance at the ball = how much time you have left.

6. Days, History & Streaks

At the first launch of each new day:

- Completed tasks are archived and written to `Documents\TerminalTasks\YYYY-MM-DD.md`.
- Unfinished tasks carry over.
- Your `/daily` rituals reseed as fresh unchecked tasks.
- The deadline resets.

Open `/log` (tab `4:LOG` in the manual) for: your **streak** gauge (consecutive days with ≥ 1 completion — today counts live), a **last-7-days** summary (`23 done • 4 active days • best Tue (8)`), your **daily rituals** list (remove with `[ x ]`), and the last 14 archived days.

7. Commands

Command	What it does
<code>/deadline HH:MM</code>	Today's deadline (one-time, clears at day end)
<code>/1 <text></code>	Add to backlog
<code>/daily <text></code>	Recurring daily ritual
<code>/log</code>	History, streak & rituals

Command	What it does
<code>/clear</code>	Clear today's tasks (Ctrl+Z restores)
<code>/export</code>	Snapshot all data to a timestamped JSON
<code>/shortcut</code>	Rebind the global hotkey — live preview while you hold modifiers; Enter saves, bare Enter resets to <code>Alt+X</code> , Esc cancels
<code>/startup</code>	Toggle launch at login
<code>/help</code> · <code>/about</code>	The manual · version & info

8. Keyboard Reference

Key	Action
<code>↑ / ↓</code>	Navigate tasks → subtasks → backlog (wraps)
<code>Space</code>	Toggle complete / promote backlog item
<code>Enter</code>	Edit selected item
<code>></code>	Subtask rapid-entry mode on selection
<code>Alt+↑/↓</code>	Reorder selected row
<code>Tab / Shift+Tab</code>	Demote / promote
<code>Backspace/Del</code>	Delete selected
<code>Ctrl+Z</code>	Undo (tasks & subtasks)
<code>Esc</code>	Cancel mode → deselect → collapse (also aborts a pending move)
<code>→ / Tab</code>	Accept command autocomplete
<code>Alt+X</code>	Global show/hide (rebindable via <code>/shortcut</code>)

9. Your Data

Everything is local. Working state lives in the app's storage and is mirrored (debounced) to:

```
Documents\TerminalTasks\
  state.json           ← live mirror; auto-restores if app storage is ever wiped
  export-*.json       ← /export snapshots
  YYYY-MM-DD.md       ← daily archive logs (human-readable Markdown)
```

Back up that folder and you've backed up the widget. Delete the app and the folder survives.

10. Tips

- Park the widget on a screen edge; `Alt+X` in, type, `Esc` out — capture in under 2 seconds.
- Use `/daily` for morning rituals and let the streak gauge guilt you kindly.

- The backlog age tags are intentional pressure: amber items are asking to be promoted or deleted.
- If the ball ever seems missing after sleep/monitor changes, it self-heals within seconds; tray → Reset Position is the manual override.